

NECESSARY HELP
Free ration being distributed at a government shop in Arjunganj, Lucknow

MANEESH AGNIHOTRI

gdb GROSS DOMESTIC BEHAVIOUR

DIVERSITY AND DISCRIMINATION

THE SLOW BLURRING OF BOUNDARIES

Caste or religious discrimination find fewer takers, but the boundaries stay firm when it comes to marriage outside faith or caste group

India, a land that prides itself on its diversity, reveals a deeply fragmented picture when it comes to acceptance and discrimination. The India Today Gross Domestic Behaviour survey explored public attitudes on social inclusivity through five key questions. While a national majority claims openness to religious and caste diversity, the data exposes entrenched biases that vary sharply across states. Kerala emerges as the beacon of inclusivity and ranks first, while Madhya Pradesh languishes at the bottom, illustrating the stark regional disparities in social attitudes across the country.

Respondents in Kerala overwhelmingly reject restrictions on food habits, oppose employment discrimination and welcome interfaith and inter-caste marriages. At the other end of the spectrum, MP, Uttar Pradesh and Uttarakhand show the

DIVERSITY AND DISCRIMINATION THE LEADERS AND THE LAGGARDS

RANK 2025	STATE
1	KERALA
2	TAMIL NADU
3	WEST BENGAL
4	MAHARASHTRA
5	CHANDIGARH
6	HARYANA
7	ASSAM
8	TELANGANA
9	RAJASTHAN
10	BIHAR
11	ANDHRA PRADESH
12	ODISHA
13	JHARKHAND
14	CHHATTISGARH
15	HIMACHAL PRADESH
16	GUJARAT
17	NCT OF DELHI
18	PUNJAB
19	KARNATAKA
20	UTTARAKHAND
21	UTTAR PRADESH
22	MADHYA PRADESH